



VP Equity Executive Report

Juan Diego Areiza

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1. Opening Remarks

Hello, my name is Juan Diego Areiza, and it is a privilege to serve as your VP Equity for the UTSU. This past month has been a productive period of transition and connection as I work to shape the equity agenda for the upcoming year.

Through ongoing dialogue with student groups, campus partners, and the executive team, I have been actively defining our strategic priorities. I am particularly enthusiastic about the momentum building around our initiatives, including efforts to enhance financial support for BIPOC students and our ongoing focus on housing advocacy. I am looking forward to a meaningful and impactful year of collaboration ahead.



2. Collaborations with Executive Team/Adjacents

This is the section for you to write down things you've collaborated with other executives/other UTSU student leaders.

2.1. President

Though there has not been anything substantive yet, we are both working with the Programs and Services team to expand the food bank and will most likely continue conversations about this moving forward.

2.2. VP Finance & Operations

Nothing substantive.

2.3. VP Public & University Affairs

The VPPUA attended a meeting I held with leadership from StudentLife to discuss scholarship/grant opportunities for BIPOC students on campus. Additionally, we have been generally discussing our plans for the year.

2.4. VP Student Life

I have kept the VP Student Life in the loop on conversations I have had with different student clubs (i.e., the Black Students Association being a big one).

2.5. VP Professional Faculties

Nothing substantive

2.6. Executive Assistant - Equity

I still need to hire an EA! Will be happening closer to July.

2.7. Board of Directors

I attended all board of directors meetings open to my position thus far. Looking forward to seeing how else I can collaborate with the board of directors.



2.8. Senate

I attended a senate meeting with the rest of the team during our executive retreat.



3. Departmental Interactions

This section contains executive interactions with various departments. Feel free to remove the ones that aren't relevant each month.

3.1. Operations

The Director of Operations and I briefly spoke about an event for Truth and Reconciliation Day, and key information to ensure Indigenous groups feel represented at this event.

3.2. Programs and Services

Terri and I had a meeting surrounding our potential partnership with ACCES, which is an employment service for students. We have also had general conversations surrounding housing and employment initiatives at the UTSU (i.e., expanding CHESS). Finally, the Programs & Services Coordinator alongside a Community Resource Specialist presented their research on food banks, which will be used to inform the expansion of the food bank.

3.3. Outreach & Engagement

The Director of Outreach & Engagement connected me with the TMSU surrounding a student-led Pride March which aligns with the goals of the UTSU. Additionally, I have been casually interacting with the Digital Marketing Coordinator to (re)post content from equity-focused student organizations through our social media accounts.



4. Executive Initiatives

This is where you add any initiatives and work in general that you've been working on in the last month!

4.1. Student Financial Aid Presentation

I am creating a presentation on student aid/funding available at the UTSU for students who identify as BIPOC. This will be presented through a StudentLife virtual conference.

4.2. BIPOC Scholarship/Grant Planning

I am conducting research on student grants available to BIPOC students, which will be used to inform the funding approved with the previous executive team.

4.3. Establishing Communication with Equity Deserving Student Groups

I have been reaching out to student groups who are equity deserving and having meetings with them. I hope to use this to inform my equity work in the coming year.

4.4. Event for Truth and Reconciliation Day

I have been reaching out to student clubs representing Indigenous students on campus. Additionally, I have been chatting with the Director of Operations about securing a space in the building for this.

4.5. Grassy Narrows River Run

Confirmed UTSU participation at the Grassy Narrows River Run.

4.6. Video for Canada VS Bosnia Soccer Game

Participated in promotional material for an upcoming screening of the Canada Vs Bosnia Soccer Game, happening at the UTSU.



4.7. Exec Retreat

Found the Airbnb + Transportation for the UTSU Exec Retreat. Drove everyone there and back. This contributed to executive team bonding.



5. External Collaborations

Here you discuss any general meetings or conversations you've had with other organizations regardless of whether there was a conclusive action item as a result or not!

5.1. NPIP Student March w/ TMSU Queer Space

Nicole reached out to me about this march. It was previously passed in the last executive meeting that we will be joining the TMSU in the march.

5.2. Adonica from StudentLife

Chatted with Adonica as a direct connection with StudentLife for two reasons: (1) Discussing financial aid for BIPOC students, (2) Connecting me with the Housing coordinator at StudentLife.

5.3. ACCES (with Terri P&S)

The Director of Programs & Services connected us to ACCES, which is an employment service for students that we want to collaborate with. We established that I would be the point person for ACCES, but also housing and employment in general at the UTSU (i.e., I will inform the executive team about any updates I get from the Director of P&S)

5.4. UofT Tri Campus Student Union Meeting

Planned a meeting with the SCSU and UTMSU to create conversation around opportunities to collaborate.

5.5. Joined Different Committees (i.e., COSS and SAC/SVPS Centre)

Became a UTSU Representative at COSS (Council of Student Services), and also became the UTSU Representative for the Student Advisory Committee (SAC) for the Sexual Violence Prevention & Support Centre (the SVPS Centre)



6. Closing Remarks

Overall, May has been a foundational month dedicated to connecting with student groups, attending key committee meetings, and laying the groundwork for upcoming initiatives like the Truth and Reconciliation Day event and BIPOC scholarship planning. While the pace started intentionally measured, I am building strong momentum in my collaborations with the executive team and external partners. I am eager to transition these planning phases into tangible impact and continue fostering an equitable campus experience throughout the coming year.